

Ἀλέξανδρος Λυκοπολίτης

## Alexander of Lycopolis on the Doctrines of the Manichaeans

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**Period:** Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)  
**Dialect:** Κοινή φιλοσοφική [Philosophical Koine](#)  
**Domain:** Θεολογία [Theology](#)  
**Format:** Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)  
**Affiliation:** [Platonist](#)

Alexander of Lycopolis was a pagan philosopher from Egypt who lived in the late third century CE. He is known only from a single surviving work, which identifies him as a thinker trained in the traditions of Plato and Aristotle. According to modern scholars, he was likely a teacher or scholar operating within this Hellenic philosophical tradition.

His only known work is a treatise titled **Against the Doctrine of Mani**. This text is a systematic critique of Manichaeism, a major dualistic religion founded by the prophet Mani. Alexander's work is significant because it is one of the earliest known pagan analyses of this emerging faith.

Rather than using religious argument, he applied Aristotelian logic and Platonic metaphysics to challenge Manichaean ideas about cosmology, the nature of good and evil, and the soul. His treatise provides valuable contemporary testimony about early Manichaean doctrines from an educated outsider's perspective.

For historians, it serves as an important source for understanding how Hellenic philosophy was used in religious debate during Late Antiquity. It illustrates the intellectual encounter between traditional Greco-Roman thought and new religious movements of the time.

### Works (1)

- [Πραγματεία Περί τῶν Μανιχαίων Δογμάτων](#) · [Treatise-the Doctrines of the Manichaeans](#) · 27 passages

### Other Platonist Authors

- [Ἀλβῖνος ὁ Πλατωνικός](#) · [Albinus the Platonist](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Πλάτωνος Θεαίτητον](#) · [Anonymous Commentary on Plato](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρίμνηστος](#) · [Arimnestus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀττικός](#) · [Atticus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Κάσσιος Λογγῖνος](#) · [Cassius Longinus the Philosopher](#) · 3 works
- [Κέλσος ὁ Πλατωνικός](#) · [Celsus the Platonist](#) · 1 work
- [Κράντωρ ὁ Σολεύς](#) · [Crantor of Soli](#) · 2 works
- [Εὐδρόμος](#) · [Eudromus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός](#) · [Heraclides of Pontus](#) · 2 works
- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός](#) · [Heraclides of Pontus II](#) · 1 work

- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus III · 1 work](#)
- [Ἀνώνυμος Προλεγόμενα εἰς τὴν Πλατωνικὴν Φιλοσοφίαν · Introduction Platonism Anonymous · 1 work](#)